Claude Monet

Name: _____ Date: _____

Read about the artist. Answer the questions in full sentences. Then complete the drawing task at the bottom.

MEET THE ARTIST

Claude Monet was born in Paris, France, in 1840. He liked to paint outdoors, quickly, to catch the way light and weather change from minute to minute. In 1874 he showed a hazy painting of a harbour at dawn called Impression, Sunrise. A critic made fun of the title, and the name stuck: Monet and his friends became known as the Impressionists. Monet often painted the same subject again and again at different times of day, such as haystacks in a field or the front of Rouen Cathedral, to show how the colours changed. Later he moved to the village of Giverny, planted a huge garden with a pond and a Japanese bridge, and spent his last thirty years painting the water lilies floating on it.

QUESTIONS

1. Why did Monet like to paint outdoors and quickly?

2. How did the Impressionists get their name?

3. Why did Monet paint the same subject many times?

4. Name two subjects he painted as a series.

5. What did Monet build at Giverny, and what did he paint there?

YOUR TURN

The same view from your window in the morning: use short dabs of colour, no outlines.

The same view at sunset: how do the colours change?

For non-commercial, education use only

Claude Monet - Answer key

1. To catch the way light and weather change from minute to minute.

2. From Monet's painting Impression, Sunrise, after a critic made fun of the title.

3. To show how the colours changed at different times of day.

4. Any two of: haystacks, Rouen Cathedral, water lilies.

5. A huge garden with a pond and a Japanese bridge; he painted the water lilies.

YOUR TURN: Drawing task; no single answer.

For non-commercial, education use only